

lyght darchnesse, that make sowre swete, & swete sowre. Who be vnto them that are wyse in theyr awne lyght, and thynke the selues to haue vnderstandyng. Who be vnto them, that are strong to suppe out wyne and experte men to sett vp dyonckenesse. These geue sentence with the vngodly for rewardes, but comdemne the iust cause of the ryghteous.

Therefore, lyke as fyre lycketh vp the strawe, and as the flame consumeth the stubble: Euen so theyr rote shalbe as corruption: and theyr blossom shal vanysh awaye lyke dust: for they haue cast awaye the lawe of the Lord of hostes, & blasphemied the word of the holy maker of Israel.

Therefore is the wrath of the Lord kindled also agaynst hys people, and he shaketh his hande at them: pee, he hath smyten, so that the hylls dyd treble. And theyr carcasses dyd lye i the open streates, lyke myre. And i all thys, the wrath of God hath not ceased, but hys hande is stretched out styll. And he shall geue a token vnto a straunge people: and call vnto the in a farre countre: and beholde, they shal come hastily with speede. There shal not be one faynt nor feeble amonge the, no not a sleggy nor sleper persone. There shal not one of the put of the gyrdle from his loynes, nor lowse theyr lachet of his shooe. Hys arrowes are sharpe, & al his bowes bent. His horse hooves are lyke flynt, & his cartwheles lyke a storme wynde. His crye is as it were of a lyon, and he roareth lyke lyons whelpes. They shal roare, & hantch vp the praye, & no man shal recouer it or get it from the. In that daye they shalbe so scarce vpon them, as the see. And yf we looke vnto the lade, beholde, it shalbe all darchnesse & sorowe. If we loke toward heauen: beholde, it shalbe darcke.

The vi. Chapter.

Elas sawe the glory of the Lord, and was sent to prophete the desolacion of Ierusalem.

In the same yere that kinge Oziah dyed, I sawe the Lord sittynge vpon an hygh and glorious seate, & his trayne fylled the temple. And aboute hym stode the Seraphims, wherof euery one had sixe wyges. With twayne eche couered his face, w twayne hys fete, and with twayne dyd he flye. They cried also eche one to ather on thys maner: holy, holy, holy, is the Lord of hostes. The whole worlde is full of his glory. Pee, y geastes and dozechetes moued at his cryng, and the house was full of smoke. Then I sayde, Who is me for I am lost in asmoch as I am a man of vncleane lippes, & dwell amonge people phath vncleane lippes also: for myne eyes haue

sene the kynge and Lord of hoostes.

Then flew one of the Seraphims vnto me, haupnge a hote cole in his hande, which he had taken from the auter with the tonges, and touched my mouth, and sayde, lo: this hath touched thy lippes, & thy syne vnghtcouines is taken awaye, & thy synne forgiven. Also, I herd the voyce of the Lord saye on this maner: Whom shall I send, and who wyl be oure messenger? Then I sayde: here am I, sende me. And he sayde, go, and tell this people: * ye shall heare in dede, but ye shall not vnderstande: ye shall playnely se, and not perceaue. Harden the harte of this people, stoppe theyr eares, ad shut theyr eyes, that they se not with theyr eyes, heare not with theyr eares, and vnderstand not with theyr hertes, and conuerte and be healed.

Then spake I: Lord, how longe? he answered: vntill the cyties be utterly wasted without inhabitours, & the houses without men, tyll the lande be also desolate, and lye vnbuylded. For the Lord shall take y men farre awaye, so that the lade shal lye waste a longe season, yet in yt shall succede .x. kinges, and the lande shall retorne and be lapde waste. And as the terebint tre and oke in winter cast ther leaues, and yet haue ther sappe in them so shall the holy lead continue in theyr substance.

The vii. Chapter.

The Syrians moue batayle agaynst Ierusalem. A byrgyn shall beare a chyld.

It happened in the tyme of Ahaz the sonne of Iotham, which was the sonne of Oziah kynge of Iuda: y* Razin the kynge of Syria, and Bechah y sonne of Romeliah, kynge of Israel: went vntoward Ierusalem to besege it, but Razin was not able to winne ye. Now when the house of Dauid (that is Ahaz) herde worde therof, y Syria & Ephraim were confederate together: his herte quaked (pee and the hertes also of his people) lyke as whan a tree in the felde is moued with the wynde.

Then sayde God vnto Elas: go mete Ahaz (thou and thy sonne Sear Jasub) at the head of the ouer pole, in the fote path by the fullers grounde, & saye vnto hym, take hede to thy selfe & be styll, but feare not, nether be faynt harted, for these two tayles: y is: for these two smokynge fyre brandes, the wrath and furiosyness of Razin the Syrian and Romelies sonne: because that the kynge of Syria Ephraim and Romelies sonne haue wickedly cōspyrred agaynst the sayng: We wyl goo vnto agaynst Iuda, bere them, and byrgne them vnder vs, and set a kynge there, euen the sonne of Tabeel. For thus

For thus sayeth the Lord God therto, It shal not so goo forth, nether come so to passe: for the head cytie of y Siria is Damascus, but the head of Damasc is Razin. And after fyue & threscore yere, shall Ephraim be no more a people. And y chefe cytie of Ephraim is Samaria, but the head of Samaria is Romelies sonne. Yf ye beleue not: it cometh of thys: that ye are vnfaythfull to God. Moreover, God spake once agayne vnto Ahaz, sayinge, requyre a token of the Lord thy God, whether it be toward the depth beneth, or toward the heygth aboue. Then sayd Ahaz: I will requyre none, nether wyl I tempte y Lord. The Lord answered: Then heare to, ye of y house of Dauid: Is it not ynough for you y ye be greuous vnto men, but ye must greue my God also? And therefore y Lord shall geue you a token: Behold, a byrgyn shall conceaue and beare a sonne, and (y hys mother) shal cal his name Emanuel. But ter ad hony shal he eate, y he maye knowe to refuse the euell, and chose the good. For oz euer the chylde come to knowledge, to eschue the euell and chose the good. The lande (that thou so Abhorrest) shalbe desolate of both her kynges. The Lord also shall sende a tyme vpon the, vpon thy people, & vpon thy fathers house (soch as neuer came sence the tyme that Ephraim departed fro Iuda) thozowe the kynge of the Assyrians. For at y same tyme shall the Lord whysle for the flies that are aboute the water of Egypt, and for the Bees in y Assyrians lade. These shal come, and shal lyght all in the desolate valeyres, in the holes of stones, vpon all thozyme and bushye places.

At the same tyme shall the Lord shal due the heare of the head and the fete and y beerd cleane of, with the rasoure that he shal hyper beyode the water: namely, with the kynge of the Assyrians. At the same tyme shall a man lyue with a kowe, and two shepe. Then, because of the aboundaunce of mylck, he shal make butter & eate it. So that euery one which remayneth in the lade, shal eate butter and hony. At the same tyme all vyneyardes (though there be a thousande vynes in one, & were solde for a thousande syluerlynges) shalbe turned to briers & thornes. Lyke as they shal come in to the lande w arrowes & bowes, so shall all the lande be come briers and thornes. And as for al hylls that are hewe downe, ther shal not come vpon the anye feare of briers & thornes. But y catell shal be dryuen thither, and the shepe shal fede there.

The viii. Chapter.

The despueraunce of the lande by Emanuel. A soue of offence, at whiche many shal stumbe.

Moreover, the lord sayd vnto me: Take y a greate leaf, & write in it, as men do w a penne, make hastye speede to robbe, & haste to y people. And I called vnto me saythfull witness to recorde. Aryah the prest, & zachariah the sonne of Barachiah. After that wet I vnto the Prophetisse, y had conceaued & borne a sonne. Then sayde the Lord to me: geue him this name: a spedie robber: an hastie spoiler. For why, oz ouer y chylde shal haue knowledge to crye father, & mother: shal the ryches of Damascus & y substaunce of Samaria be taken awaye by y spoiler, before the kynge of the Assyrians.

The Lord spake also vnto me, sayinge: For so moch as thys people refuseth the still rennyng water of Sylo, and put theyr delpte in Razin & Romelies sonne: Behold, the Lord shall byrgne myghtie & greate floudes of water vpon them: namely, the kynge of the Assyrians with all his power: Which shal clyme vp vpo all his floudes, and renne ouer all theyr banckes. And shal breake in vpon Iuda, flowinge & increasig in power, tyll he gett hi by y neck. He shal fyl also the widenesse of thy lande with hys brode winges, Emanuel. Breake downe (o ye peple of Assur) and ye shal be, broke downe: herken to all ye of farre countrees. Muster you, and you shalbe broken downe, prepare you to batell and you shal be toyme in pecces: take your counsell together, yet must your counsell come to naught: go in hande withall, yet shal it not prospere: for God is with vs. For the Lord spake thus to me in the powre of his hande, & warned me, sayinge vnto me: that I shulde not walcke in the waye of this people.

He sayde moreover: rounde with none of the, whosoeuer saye: ponder people are bounde together: feare them not, nether be afraid of them, but sanctifie the Lord of hostes, lett hym be your feare and dyede. For he shal be the holy place to flye to, and stone to stumbe at: the rock to fall vpon: a snare and net to both the houses of Israel, and the inhabitours of Ierusalem.

And many shal stumbe, fall, and be broke vpon hym: pee, they shalbe snared & taken. Now laye the witness together & seale the lawe w my disciples. Thus wil I wayte vpon the Lord that hath turned his face from the house of Jacob, and I will loke for him. But lo, as for me, and the children which the lord hath geuen me: we are a token and a wondre in Israel, for the Lord of hostes sake, which dwelleth vpon the hyll of Sion.

And yf they saye vnto you: aske counsell at the sothelayers, witches, charmers and conurers, then make them thys answer.

Is there